

... special color, special interior.... [They] ordered it about four months before [I found out about it] Still had about five months [before delivery].

How do you go ... and tell somebody who [wants to] give you a Rolls-Royce that you don't want it?

Why did Mr. Allan refuse to accept such a marvelous gift?

There's nothing the Rolls-Royce represents that's important in my life. Nor would I want to have to change my life to go along with [owning] the Rolls. I can't throw fish in the back seat of the Rolls, like I do right now when I go fishing. I'm gonna have to get you all to the lake.... I'm out fishing here every weekend. We have some of the best freshwater fishing in the country. Right out here ... where I keep my fishing boat.

Mr. Allan's type of fishing includes throwing bloody fish in the back seat of his four-year-old, full-sized, American-made, nonluxury vehicle. But such behavior is incongruent with driving a Rolls-Royce down to the lake. It would be out of place. Mr. Allan would not feel comfortable with such a vehicle. Thus, he contended, he had to change his behavior by ceasing to fish or refuse the gift.

Let's consider Mr. Allan's dilemma further. His office is located in his manufacturing plant, which is in an old industrial area. An automobile like the one being offered might well be out of place in such an environment. And, of course, Mr. Allan does not want to operate two vehicles. That would be inefficient. Mr. Allan also feels that a luxury car would alienate many of his workers. They might get the feeling that their boss was exploiting them. How else could he afford such an expensive vehicle? There are other considerations as well:

With a Rolls, I can't go to some of the crummy restaurants I enjoy going to.... Can't drive up in a Rolls-Royce. So, no, thank you. And so I had to call and say, "I really got to tell you something. That I don't want it." It's totally unimportant.... There are some things that are more fun to do ... more interesting to do [than owning a Rolls].